for all caste segments. So, in these fifteen-member booth committees, three would be Brahmins, three Thakurs, three Baniya, many more OBCs were brought in.' Importantly, while the BJP had always had notional district-level elections, these were held seriously and ruthlessly in 2013, leading to a major turnover in the party's district-level leadership. This was done to finetune the organisation and they were 'particular about the other caste combinations. That is why they won so many election victories.'[51] (Chapter 8 details how these organisational structures were set up and how they operated.)

The party became so mindful of caste numbers for OBCs that, in many districts, it 'held off appointments of presidents till they found Lodh Rajput OBCs'.[52] A case in point is that of Lucknow, where Mukesh Sharma, a Brahmin, was the city BJP president. When it came to appointing the district president, there was tremendous pressure to appoint someone from among the upper-caste leaders. The party leadership postponed the announcement, dropped many names that came before them and put off a decision till they found an OBC, Shrikrishna Lodh, who was named district president.

The BJP's primary aim was to have a 'sangathan [organisation] in each booth', explains Deputy Chief Minister K.P. Maurya when I ask him about the significance of these district-level elections. Once booth-level committees and presidents were elected, he says, the 'booth president was given the status of a malik [boss]. Earlier they didn't get much status, were not given the kind of respect they should get. Earlier, ordinarily we used to look for them only when we had to give them an election bag. The organisation was only up to this level earlier. But BJP moved much far ahead of this and organised booth presidents first by region, then by district and then by Vidhan Sabha. We did many sammelans with them.'[53] Maurya became party president in April 2016 and these sammelans started in July 2016. 'The last programme was held in Ramabhai Ambedkar Park, which was addressed by PM Narendra Modi. This was a sammelan of booth presidents where we first gave the slogan "*Ab ki baar 300 paar*" [this time we'll cross 300] and we got 325 seats.' Once this structure was in place, the party used it for specific outreach to key target groups. It held a series of 'separate OBC sammelans with OBCs, women sammelans and youth sammelans,'